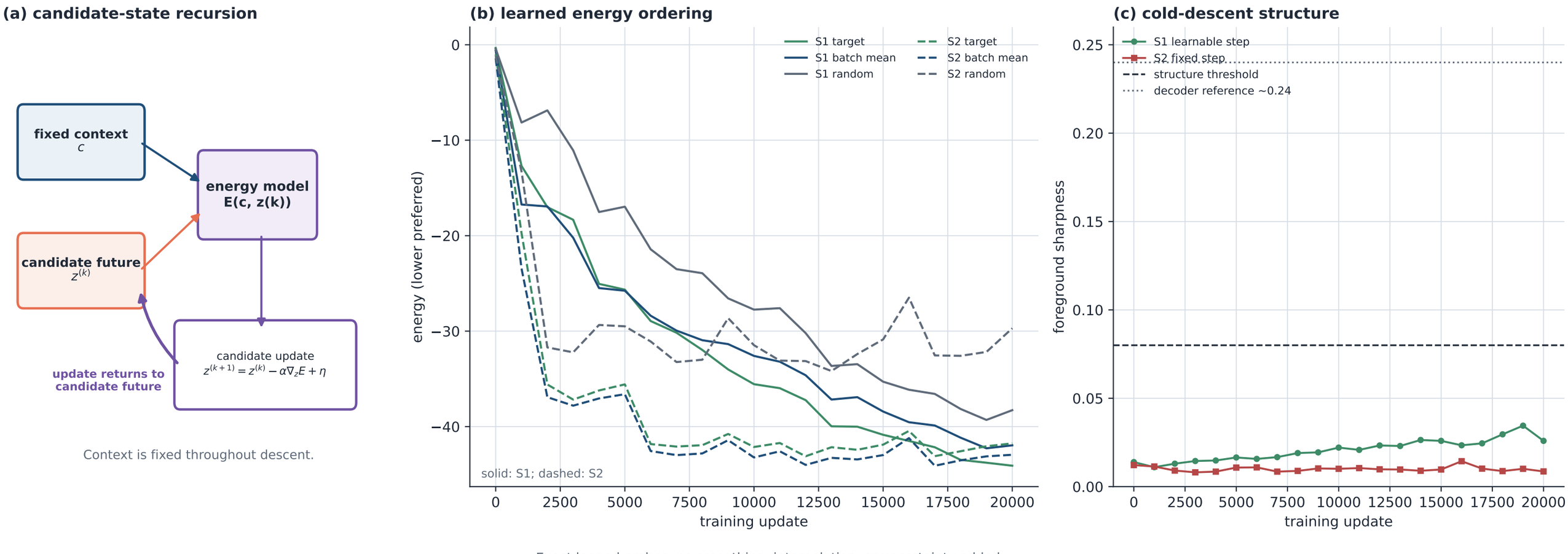
Energy ordering can improve while candidate descent remains unreachable



Exact logged probes; no smoothing, interpolation, or uncertainty added.